INSIDE THE MIND OF AN IT EXPERT

Proven Approaches to Cybersecurity Protection

Online gaming is a passion for the new generation. However it has become a threat to the younger generation. Children are unknowingly exposed to threats such as cyberbullying. While playing in competitive virtual worlds, children appear to be at a number of digital risks. These include identity theft, privacy invasion, malicious software, cyber bullying, phishing scams, as well as unsolicited contacts from Internet predators. A proactive approach with nuanced parental involvement preserves kids' experiences by allowing parents, guardians and educators to understand these problems as well as suggesting basic precautions to reduce exposure to these issues. "Approaches using machine learning (ML) techniques can detect child predatory behavior," says Jayakanth Pujuri an Information Technology professional with high level expertise in machine learning and cybersecurity. Initially he accomplished his Bachelor degree in Computer and Information technology from Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, India and Masters of Science in Computer Science and Engineering from Southern Arkansas University, USA. In a conversation with Nibedita Behera, Mr. Pujuri discusses many social issues and its solutions using advanced Information Technology.



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Q: What are the risks a child may face while playing Online Games?
Cyberbullying is a kind of harassment of someone over digital mediums, including text messages, social media, or online gaming platforms.

Q: How to keep kids safe when gaming online?
Parents are requested to stay alert, it is important to put parental control over child's device, stay involved, restrictions from in-App payments, try to divert his/her mind in other mode of activities, staying vigilant even if you allow to play online, restrict time over devices, stay involved with your kids.

Q: How is the cyber world affecting adults?
Cybercrimes are affecting almost all ages of individuals. Financial, social media, cyber threats and attacks are common now a days. Common factors are phishing attacks through emails, sending SMS and calls and getting banking access these are common now a days.

Q: How is cybercrime affecting people mentally?
Digital isolation is almost impossible these days. We cannot think of not using social media, messengers, online shopping and every aspect of our daily life. In this digital age loneliness have become more than an emotional burden, it's a vulnerability that cybercriminal are keen to exploit. As the screen time becomes longer the more vulnerable it becomes for cyber threats. A lonely person is likely to get engaged with strangers and here comes the risk of cyber fraud.

Q: What are your thoughts for remaining vigilant and positive from digital isolation?
It is more important to physically meet friends rather than communicating over any social platforms. Spending times with friends can reduce screentime and hence the risk of cyber fraud decreases. Incorporating the principles of Ikigai into your approach of life where continuous learning can transform how you perceive your educational and professional endeavors. Its important to stay open minded and making positive impact in life.

Q: What are your views to stay away from these digital distractions ?
The objective of leading a impactful life can be inspired by a village in Japan called Ogimi which is known as village of longevity. Average life span of people there is over 100 years. People here believe in plant-based diets and practice gardening, the main philosophy is patience, rhythm and acceptance. Spending time with nature they remove stress and stay together with happiness. These activities can impact living a less stressful time and remove the various burden that can distract us from the screen time and remain healthy and happy.

Q: What is your take home message of remaining safe in this era of cyber crime?
Maintaining simple steps. One should be vigilant in staying away from from attacks. Keeping your software and operating system updated, use anti-virus software and keep it updated, do not open attachments in spam emails, use strong passwords, do not click on links in spam emails or untrusted websites, do not give out personal information unless required and check if its secure, keeping an eye on your bank statements for any unknown transactions contact your banks, using your social media accounts carefully.